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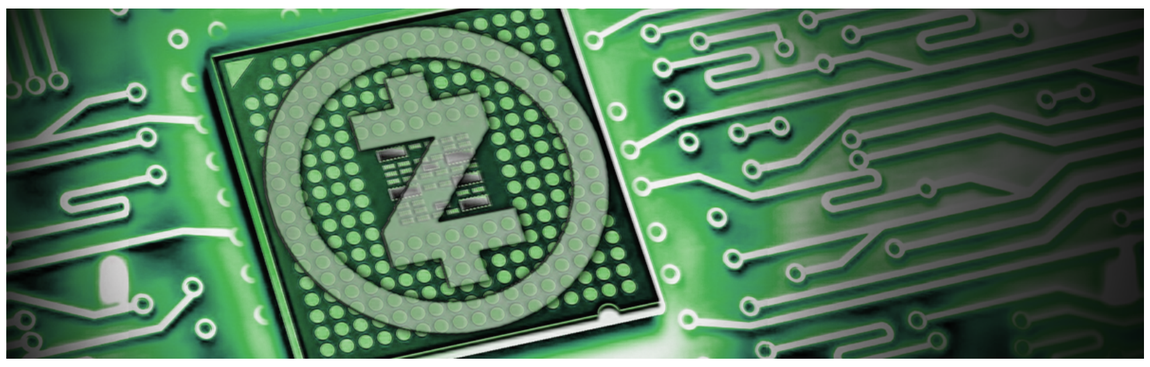
How to mine Zcash - ZEC (Windows)

86 comments | Antonio Madeira | 27 Feb 2017 | 718.75 k



ZCash is an anonymous cryptocurrency that uses zk-snarks to ensure that all the information regarding user transactions is safely encrypted, while still verifiable by miners that can ensure no double-spending has taken place using zero knowledge proofs.

ZCash uses **Equihash** as an hashing algorithm, which is an asymmetric memory-hard PoW algorithm based on the generalized birthday problem. It relies on high RAM requirements to bottleneck the generation of proofs and making ASIC development unfeasible, much like Ethereum.

Not everyone has access to a computer, however, and not everyone has the time, knowledge or patience to start mining Zcash on their own, especially since there is no Graphic User Interface (GUI) Miner available yet. If you want to mine on your own computer, but need a little push to do so, you're in the right place. But if you're looking to profit from Zcash mining with no effort at all, **this guide will do the trick**.

Today we are going to show you how to mine Zcash with your CPU and GPU on Windows. We are going to use two miners (Software) for each type of hardware: Nicehash miner for CPU and the claymore miner for GPU.

If you want to use the Nicehash miner for both hardware types, follow this guide.

If you are new to crypto mining, you can take advantage of the easy-to-use PandaPool's GUI miner. Please follow guide.

You can also try buying a cloud mining contract with Hashflare or Genesis Mining.

Choosing a wallet and a mining pool

In order to mine using this guide, there are two things that you'll need. The first is a wallet to store your funds. There are currently multiple GUI wallets available and you can compare them here. You can also use this guide to learn how to install one of them on Linux. It is also possible to use an exchange as a wallet but we do not recommend it.

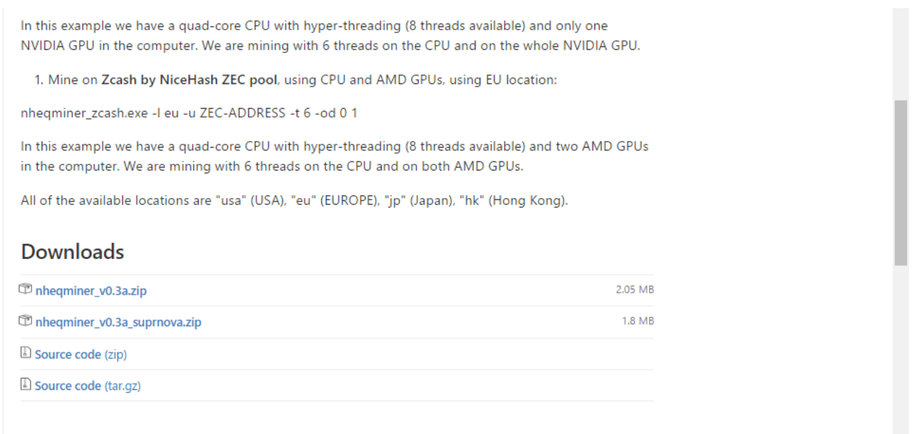
You will also need a mining pool to direct your hashing power to. You can compare features and reviews on multiple Zcash pools here. We are going to choose nicehash pool for this guide, but it will work with any poo

Now that you have both your wallet and pool at the ready, it's time to get digging.

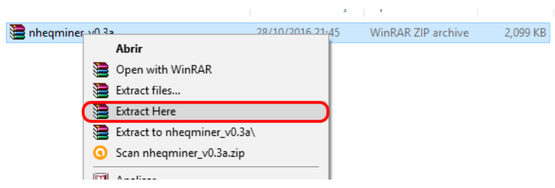
Mining ZCash with your CPU (Windows)

For the CPU part of this guide, we are going to use Nicehash miner. While this miner works for both CPU and GPU, we are going to get the best performance if we use different miners for CPU and GPU. This is because the Claymore miner is faster but only works for CPU.

Step 1: Click **here** to download the Nicehash miner. Scroll down for the latest releases



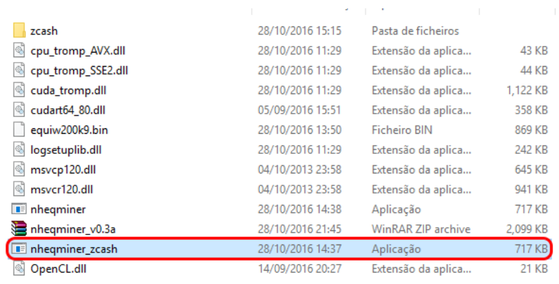
Step 2: Extract the files within the .zip



In order to use this miner, you must specify how many cores you have for maximum performance. You can check your CPU core count by opening the Task Manager and going to the performance section.

The NiceHash miner comes with 2 versions. one to get paid in Bitcoin (**nheqminer**), and another one to get paid directly in zcash (**nheqminer_zcash**).

Step 3: Open the "**nheqminer_zcash**" file



Step 4: In order to start mining with your CPU type or paste the following command with the required modifications:

nheqminer_zcash.exe -l eu -u ZEC-ADDRESS -t 8

Replace "**eu**" for your mining pool address found on the pool "Get Started" page, "**ZEC-ADDRESS**" for your zcash wallet address (transparent address) and lastly replace "**-t 8**" for the number of threads you want to use. (If you're using the Nicehash pool, you can use -l to specify your location like "eu" for Europe)

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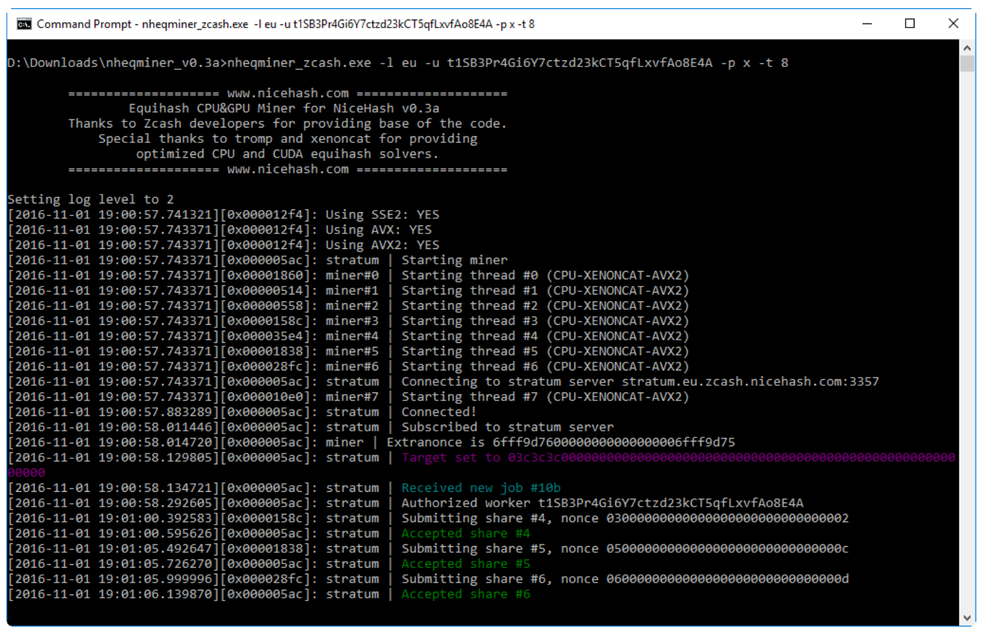


Mining ZCash with your GPU (Windows x64)

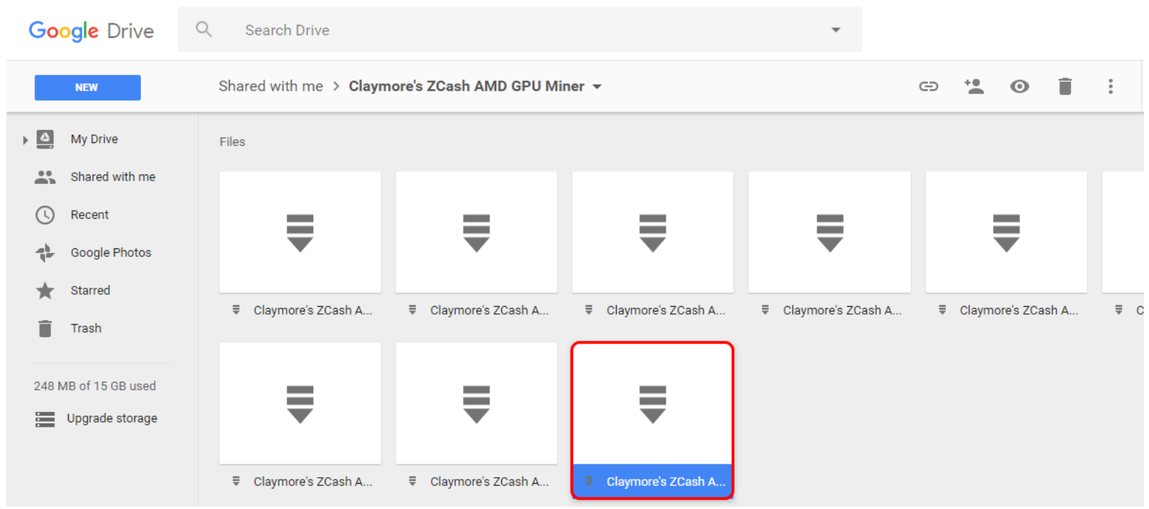
On the GPU side, we are going to use the **Claymore** miner. Claymore has a long-standing reputation for optimizing miners and this miner speaks for it. It improves the hashing rate considerably and that is why we are going to take the time to download and use this miner as well. The genoil miner only works for pool mining and with AMD graphic cards. This miner charges a 2.5% developer fee. Every hour the miner mines for the developer during 90 seconds. However, the performance increase is well worth the fee charged. If you don't agree with the dev feem, don't use this miner

Catalyst (Crimson) 15.12 is required for best performance and compatibility. You can get very bad results for different drivers version, or miner can fail on startup.

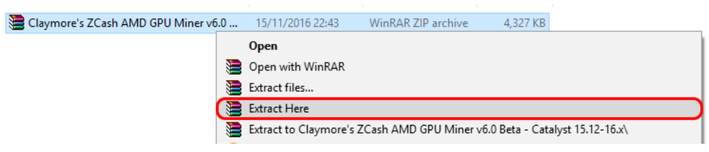
For multi-GPU systems, set Virtual Memory size in Windows at least 16 GB:
"**Computer Properties / Advanced System Settings / Performance / Advanced / Virtual Memory**".

Step 1: Click here to download the Claymore Zcash miner. (Alternative link)

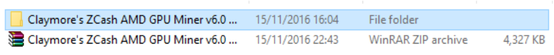
Step 2: Choose a version and download it. The latest version is at the bottom right.



Step 3: Extract the files within the .zip



Step 4: Open the "**Claymore's ZCash AMD GPU Miner v6.0 Beta**" folder

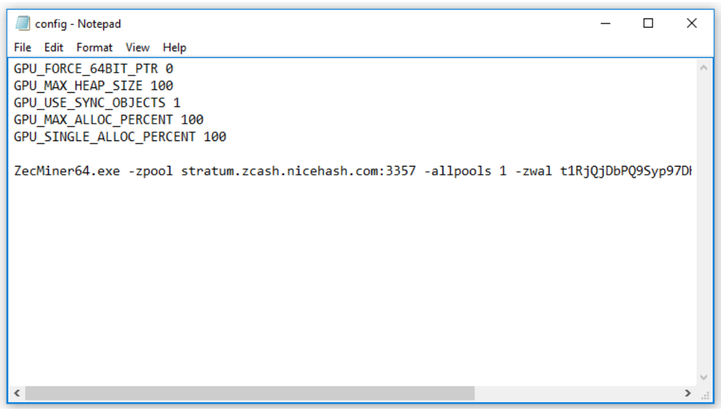


Step 5: Open the "**config.txt**" file with your notepad and enter the following configuration:

GPU_FORCE_64BIT_PTR 0
GPU_MAX_HEAP_SIZE 100
GPU_USE_SYNC_OBJECTS 1
GPU_MAX_ALLOC_PERCENT 100
GPU_SINGLE_ALLOC_PERCENT 100

ZecMiner64.exe -zpool stratum.zcash.nicehash.com:3357 -allpools 1 -zwal t1RjQjDbPQ9Syp97DHFyzvgZhcjgLTMwhaq.YourWorkerName -zpsw x

Replace "**stratum.zcash.nicehash.com:3357**" with your pool's server. and replace "**t1RjQjDbPQ9Syp97DHFyzvgZhcjgLTMwhaq**" with your zcash wallet address. Optionally, replace "**YourWorkerName**". If you want, you can also replace "**x**" with your password.



You can check out the full list of commands here.

If you followed all the steps, you should see something like this:

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```
C:\Users\Paulie\Desktop\Claymore's ZCash AMD GPU Miner v5.0 Beta>ZecMiner64.exe -zpool
-zwal t1SB3Pm4G16Y7rtrd23KCTsgfLxufAoBE4A

        Claymore's ZCash AMD GPU Miner v5.0 Beta

ZEC: 1 pool is specified
Main ZCash pool is stratum.zcash.nicehash.com:3357

Catalyst 15.12 is REQUIRED for best performance and compatibility
At least 16 GB of Virtual Memory is required for multi-GPU systems
Make sure you defined GPU_MAX_ALLOC_PERCENT 100
Be careful with overclocking, use default clocks for first tests
Press "s" for current statistics, "0".."9" to turn on/off cards, "r" to reload pools
NOTE: miner uses 500 rounds to calculate average speed, so it may take up to a minute to get correct speed.
OpenCL initializing...

AMD Cards available: 1
GPU #0: Tahiti, 3072 MB available, 32 compute units
GPU #0 recognized as Radeon 280X/380X
POOL version
GPU #0 intensity 0
Total cards: 1
"-allpools" option is set, default pools can be used for devfee, check "Readme" file for details.
ZEC: Stratum - connecting to 'stratum.zcash.nicehash.com' <169.47.24.145> port 3357
Watchdog enabled
Remote management is enabled on port 3333

ZEC: Stratum - Connected (stratum.zcash.nicehash.com:3357)
Pool sets new share target: 0x03c3c3c0 (diff: 68H)
ZEC: Share accepted!
ZEC: Authorized
```

Now that you've got your hands dirty, just sit back and watch your zcash roll in! Be aware that you are mining to a transparent address (it starts with t). You can follow this guide to learn how to create a private and transparent wallet.

Comments

What is your opinion on How to mine Zcash - ZEC (Windows)? (You will be banned if you post affiliate / referral links. Please keep the conversation civilized and remember, we're all in this together!)

Post

arpitpupu
1 year ago

THW GDRIVE IS ASKING FOR ACCESS I HAVE REQUESTED YOU THE ACCESS PLEASE GIVE IT

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ltcmine.io/?r=259
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I successfully join the mining team early this month and here is my story. It all started when i saw an old friend driving a new 2019 Bentley....I was so amazed because we attend the same college but we lost contact after all that. We got talking and i asked him about his work and he made me understand he's into cryptocurrency. I started my own research to know more about crypto's and also watched a lot of videos on youtube. I saw everyone joining one prof. Sydney mining team and i saw a lot of positive comments on Facebook, Instagram and other social media platforms. I began to wonder if this true. I put the prof email and his info on google, Did you believe i didn't see any negative review....I realize he is a man of integrity so i email him. The prof explained everything for me in detailed and made me understand how he mine bitcoins for a lot of his student i am really interested....Prof guide me on how to setup my own crypto wallet and we get going to the final stage. I am proud to say i have been working with prof since early this month and i have got 10.56785 btc mined in total. I am very grateful for what the prof have done in my life because i've joined his mining team now, also his Telegram group for Elites. I believe i will be able to get my own mind blowing car in few months because crypto money is unlimited. I can't stop thanking this man. I wish i could do more than publicizing his good work. He is the best with good manner of approach.....I will advise you to email the proof right away if you need any info on crypto mining. (Profsydneycryptoconsultancy@gmail.com).

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bit.ly/2Xfprj3
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bit.ly/2GquTKi
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mrtriasu
4 years ago

Nice article, thanks for the information. Also, the best way to earn Zcash is going to here: zcashrates.com.

reply Agree

Medicus
4 years ago

i can really recommed you guys this minign rig its perfect for zec mining im really satisified with those! goo.gl/Ee256r

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ygriffiny
4 years ago

Argo Blockchain (LSE listed) are offering 2000 sol/s packages at $25 per month for the first month (October) now. Be quick though.

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bogdanmasca
4 years ago

ZEC AUTHORIZATION FAILED
(id 2 , result false "error:null")
What does this mean i have followed all of the seps i`m using the claymore miner and mining pool hub. i chose at pwal my worker id because that is what mind pool hub asked for. Ive put a password and nothing

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antal-ishtvan
4 years ago

nice article, I will try, thank you!
btw has anyone started zcash mining using this tutorial?

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equihash_mining
4 years ago

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- Zencash

reply Agree

bobsav2121
4 years ago

Could someone help me out here. I've got a R280X that should run around 290 h/s on equihash. I runs great guns on Cryptonite 485 h/s but when I start Claymore Zen64 miner it starts out at 275 h/s and then starts to throttle back to 150 h/s. It drops my clock speed in half and I have no control over setting thru MSI afterburner. It mines along but at half the speed 500mhz.
Bob

reply Agree

adigheboianu
4 years ago

Is there a Claymore ZCash miner for Nvidia GPUs running on Windows?

reply Agree

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